

Ranking Personal Development Books

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 07, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/rgEOFQD7Kt0> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter does a blind ranking of five popular growth and discipline books, ordering them 1–5 based on quick gut reactions, with Ryan Holiday's work taking the top spot.

Contents

-  The Rankings Revealed

The Rankings Revealed 0:00

- Format: books are presented to Brandon one at a time and he slots each into a ranked list on the spot ("blind ranking")
- **#1 — Ego Is the Enemy** (Ryan Holiday)
 - Immediately placed at number one
 - Reasoning: "Ryan Holiday is my favorite author"
- **#2 — Rich Dad Poor Dad** (Robert Kiyosaki)
 - Acknowledged it may not be a traditional self-improvement book
 - His logic: "If you get more money you're improving yourself" — so it qualifies
- **#3 — The Miracle Morning** (Hal Elrod)
 - Called "a good book" — placed solidly in the middle
- **#4 — Daring Greatly** (Brené Brown)
 - No elaboration given; slotted at four by default
- **#5 — Make Your Bed** (Admiral William H. McRaven)
 - Placed last with no additional commentary

Rank	Book	Author	Comment
1	Ego Is the Enemy	Ryan Holiday	Favorite author
2	Rich Dad Poor Dad	Robert Kiyosaki	Money = self-improvement
3	The Miracle Morning	Hal Elrod	"A good book"
4	Daring Greatly	Brené Brown	No comment

Rank	Book	Author	Comment
5	Make Your Bed	Adm. McRaven	No comment